

かきじゅん

STROKE ORDER

Kanadoku · Hiragana and Katakana

All 92 kana in the book, hiragana and katakana, drawn stroke by stroke at three times the size the book's practice pages use. Free to print, free to share.

Katakana start from page 10. The voicing marks, a small kana and the long bar follow each alphabet, on pages 9 and 15.



Reading the diagrams

Each square holds one kana with a small number at the start of every stroke, in the order the strokes are drawn. Follow them in sequence and you are writing the kana the way it is written. The dotted cross is there to judge proportion: most of a kana's legibility lives in how it sits in the square rather than in the strokes themselves.

Two rules cover almost everything, and both are visible in every diagram here: top before bottom, and left before right. Where a line crosses another, the horizontal one usually comes first: た is drawn across, then down. Kanji follow the same two rules, so what you learn here carries straight over.

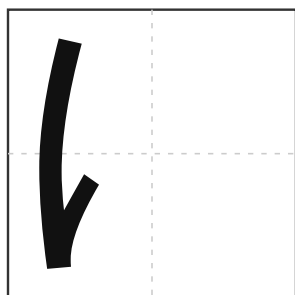
Stroke order is not pedantry. It is what keeps kana legible when you write them quickly, and in two pairs, シ and ツ and ソ and ン, it is the only thing that tells the letters apart (page 3). It is also how handwriting recognition on a phone decides what you meant.

The kana run in the order of the kana chart, あ い う え お, then か き く け こ and on to ん, hiragana first and then katakana. That is the order of the writing practice at the back of the book, so keep this beside those pages and the two stay in step. Under each diagram is the printed form, its stroke count, its romaji, and the same sound in the other alphabet.

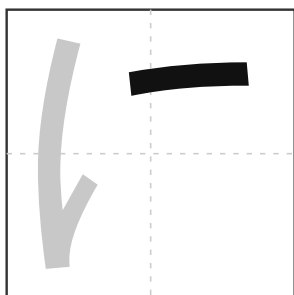
Copy this, please. It is free to print and free to share, whole and unmodified, including by teachers and study groups. It may not be sold. The latest version is always at kanjidoku.net/strokes.

One kana, three strokes

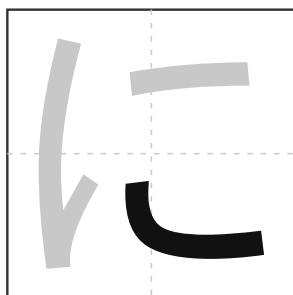
に is *ni*, and both rules are in it: the upright on the left comes first, then the two lines on the right, top one first. The new stroke is black in each square and the ones already drawn are grey.



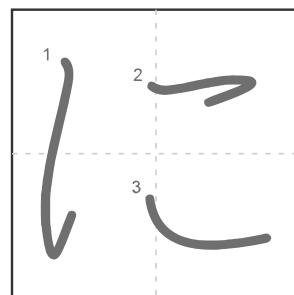
1 down the left



2 the short line



3 the longer one



as this document draws it

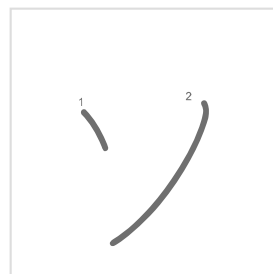
Same strokes, different directions



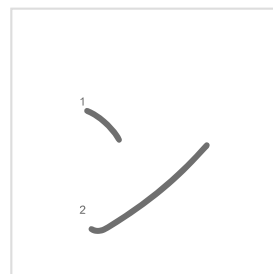
し shi



つ tsu



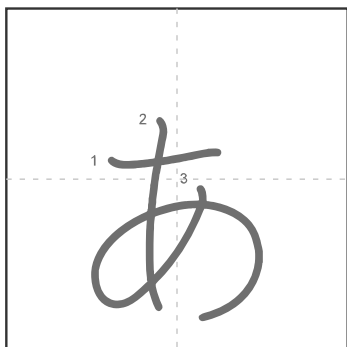
そ so



ん n

Printed, し and つ are two short marks and a long one, and そ and ん are one short mark and a long one. What tells each pair apart is where the strokes start and which way the long one travels.

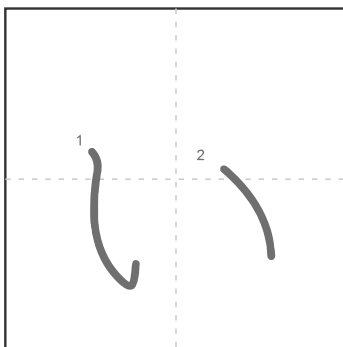
し stacks its short strokes down the left side, and its long stroke starts at the bottom left and sweeps up to the right. つ lines its short strokes up along the top, and its long stroke starts at the top right and comes down. そ and ん are the same pair with one short stroke fewer: そ's long stroke comes down from the top, ん's goes up from the bottom left. Written quickly, the direction is all that is left to read, so it is worth getting right from the start.



あ hiragana • 3 strokes

a

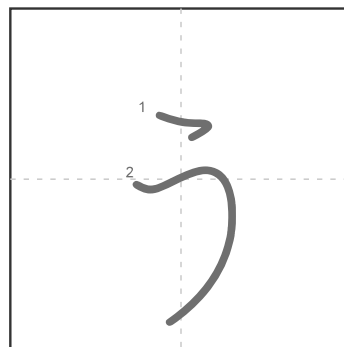
katakana ア



い hiragana • 2 strokes

i

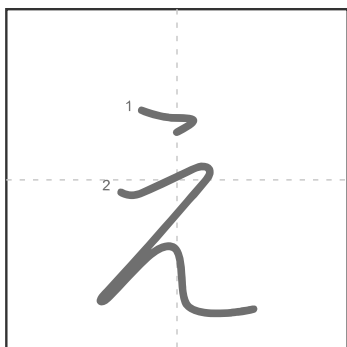
katakana イ



う hiragana • 2 strokes

u

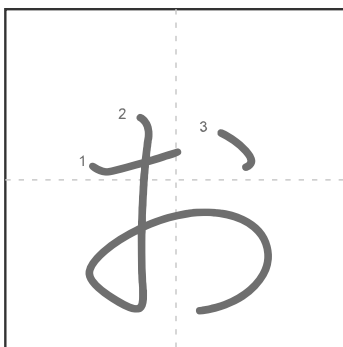
katakana ウ



え hiragana • 2 strokes

e

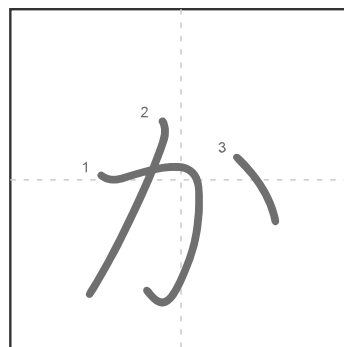
katakana エ



お hiragana • 3 strokes

o

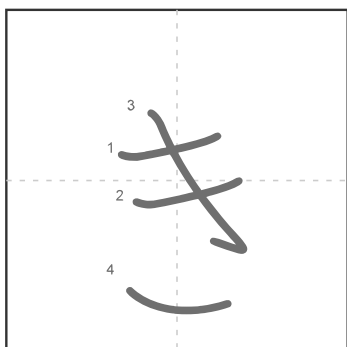
katakana オ



か hiragana • 3 strokes

ka

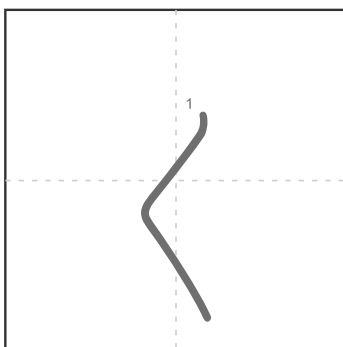
katakana カ



き hiragana • 4 strokes

ki

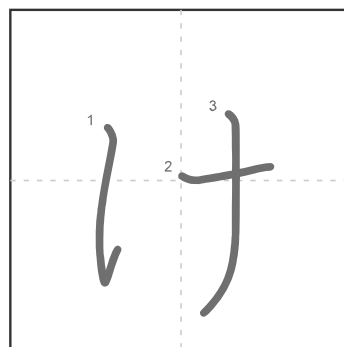
katakana キ



く hiragana • 1 stroke

ku

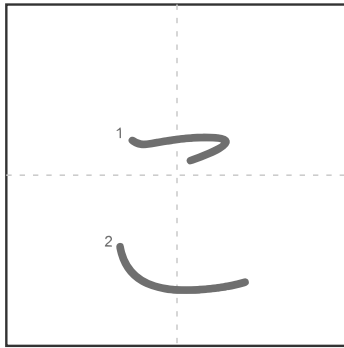
katakana ク



け hiragana • 3 strokes

ke

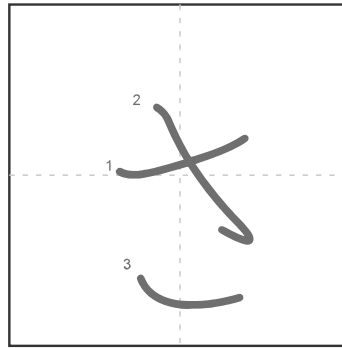
katakana ケ



こ hiragana • 2 strokes

ko

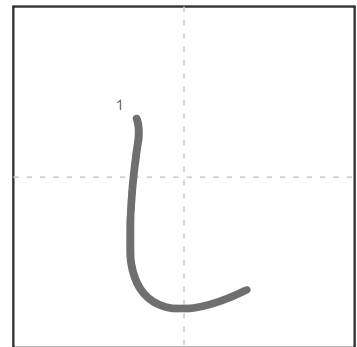
katakana コ



さ hiragana • 3 strokes

sa

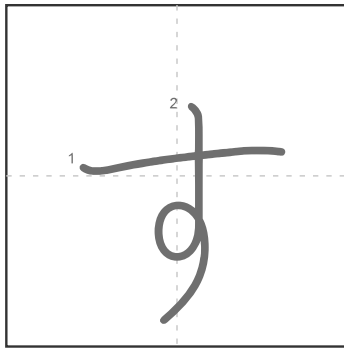
katakana サ



し hiragana • 1 stroke

shi

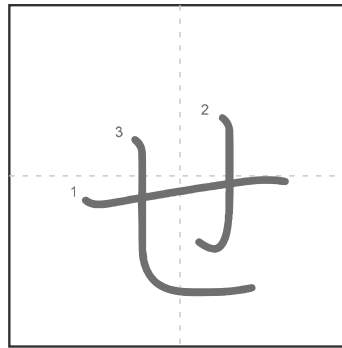
katakana シ



す hiragana • 2 strokes

su

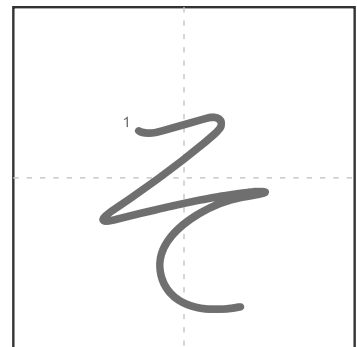
katakana ス



せ hiragana • 3 strokes

se

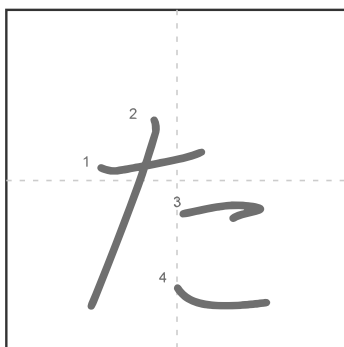
katakana セ



そ hiragana • 1 stroke

so

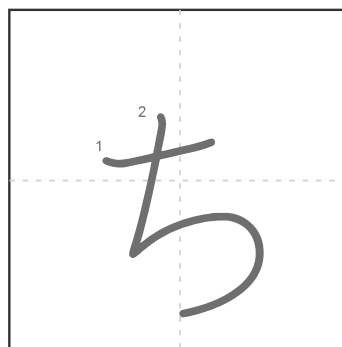
katakana ソ



た hiragana • 4 strokes

ta

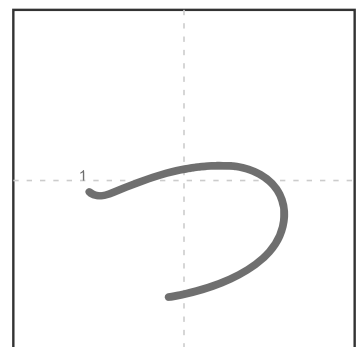
katakana タ



ち hiragana • 2 strokes

chi

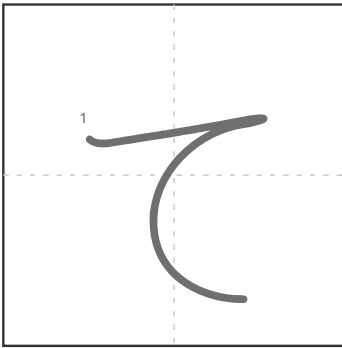
katakana チ



つ hiragana • 1 stroke

tsu

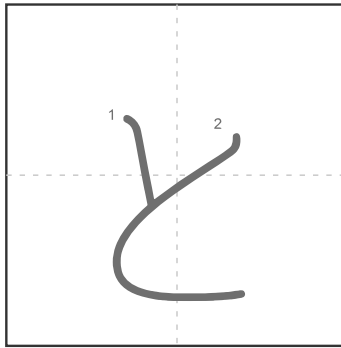
katakana ツ



て hiragana • 1 stroke

te

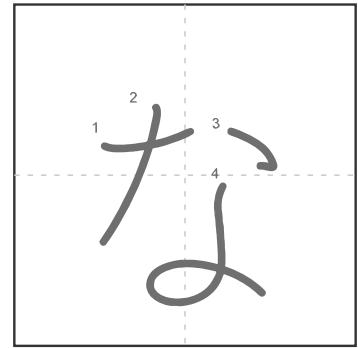
katakana テ



と hiragana • 2 strokes

to

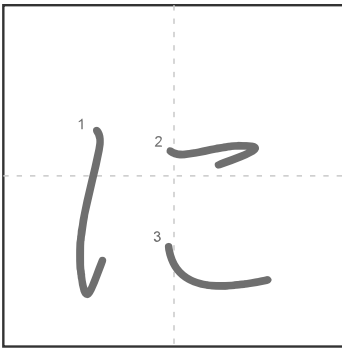
katakana ト



な hiragana • 4 strokes

na

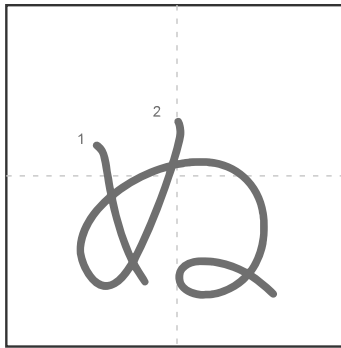
katakana ナ



に hiragana • 3 strokes

ni

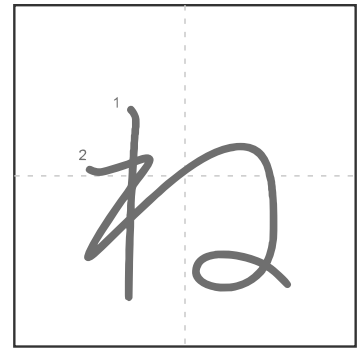
katakana ニ



ぬ hiragana • 2 strokes

nu

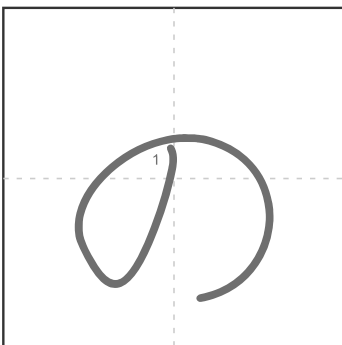
katakana ヌ



ね hiragana • 2 strokes

ne

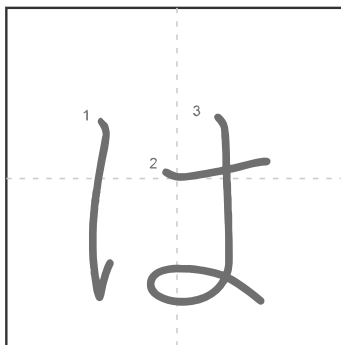
katakana ネ



の hiragana • 1 stroke

no

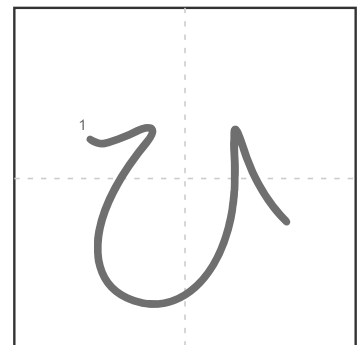
katakana ノ



は hiragana • 3 strokes

ha

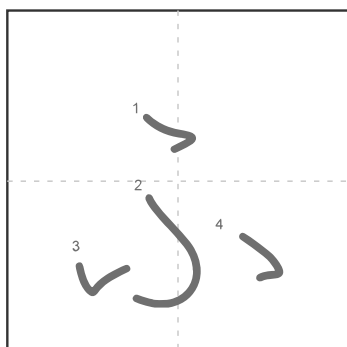
katakana ハ



ひ hiragana • 1 stroke

hi

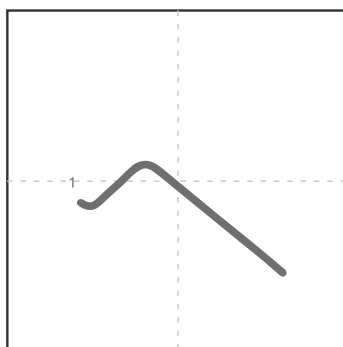
katakana ヒ



ふ hiragana • 4 strokes

fu

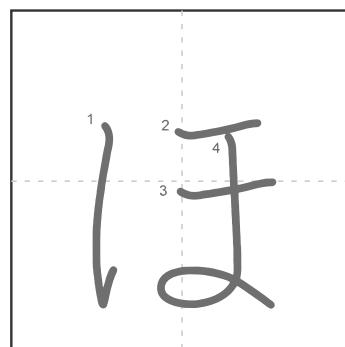
katakana フ



へ hiragana • 1 stroke

he

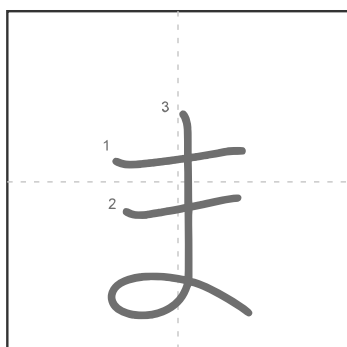
katakana ヘ



ほ hiragana • 4 strokes

ho

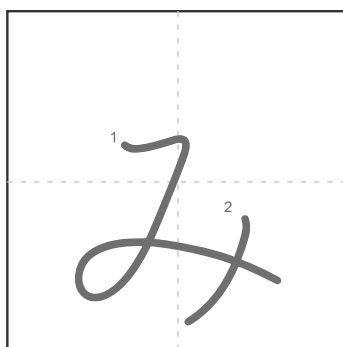
katakana ホ



ま hiragana • 3 strokes

ma

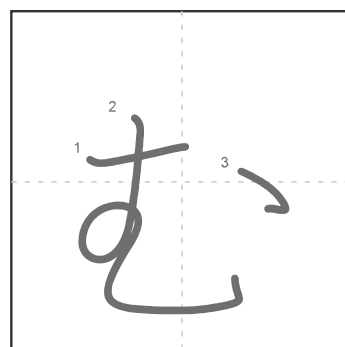
katakana マ



み hiragana • 2 strokes

mi

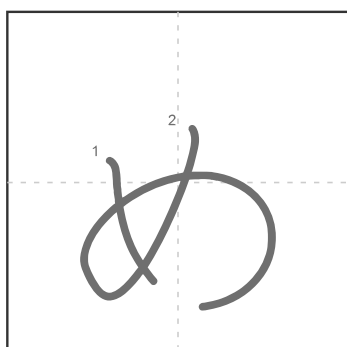
katakana ミ



む hiragana • 3 strokes

mu

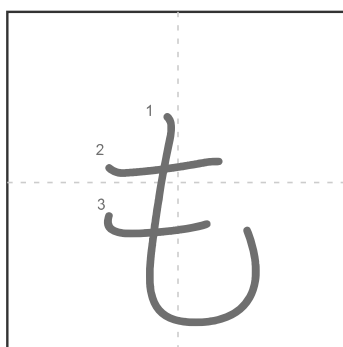
katakana ム



め hiragana • 2 strokes

me

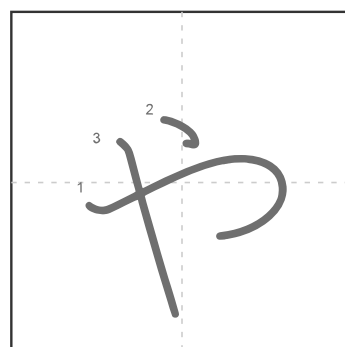
katakana メ



も hiragana • 3 strokes

mo

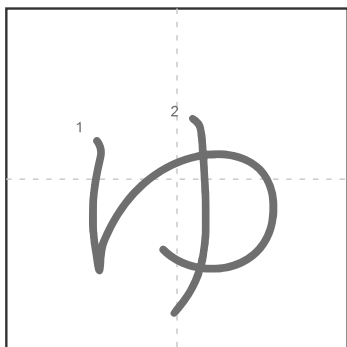
katakana モ



や hiragana • 3 strokes

ya

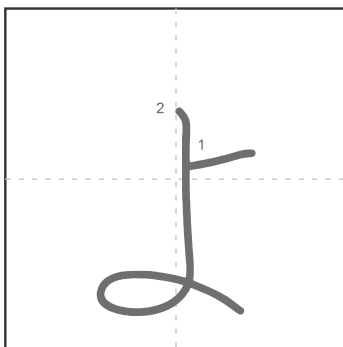
katakana ヤ



ゆ hiragana • 2 strokes

yu

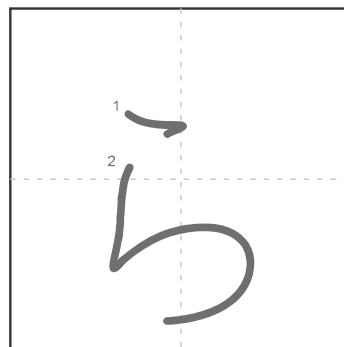
katakana ユ



よ hiragana • 2 strokes

yo

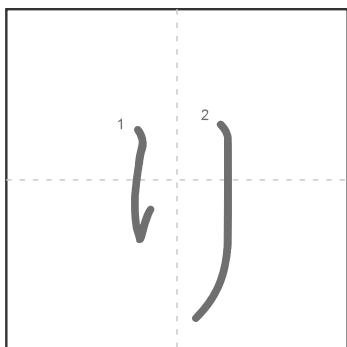
katakana ヨ



ら hiragana • 2 strokes

ra

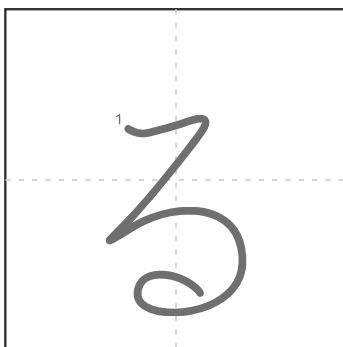
katakana ラ



り hiragana • 2 strokes

ri

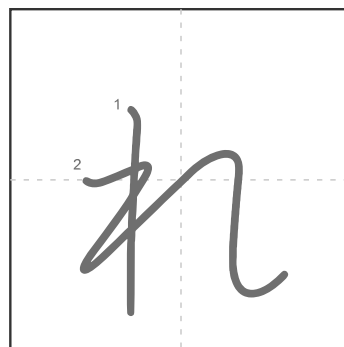
katakana リ



る hiragana • 1 stroke

ru

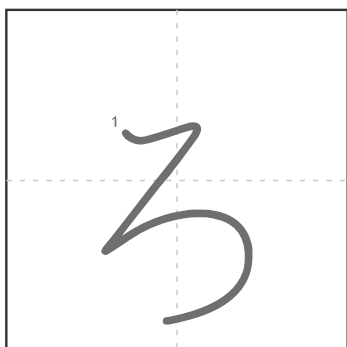
katakana ル



れ hiragana • 2 strokes

re

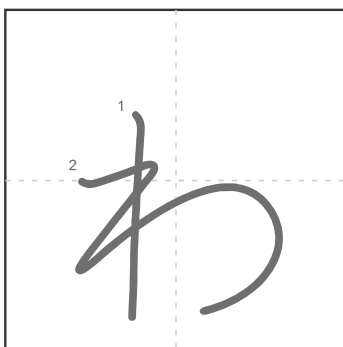
katakana レ



ろ hiragana • 1 stroke

ro

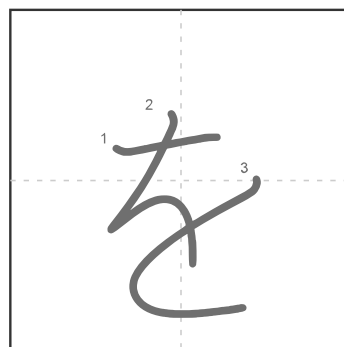
katakana ロ



わ hiragana • 2 strokes

wa

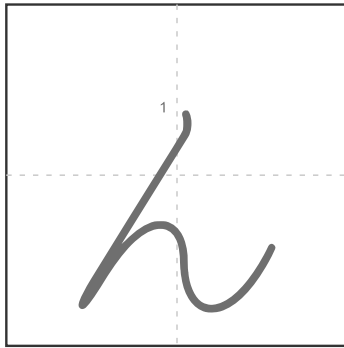
katakana ワ



を hiragana • 3 strokes

wo

katakana ヲ



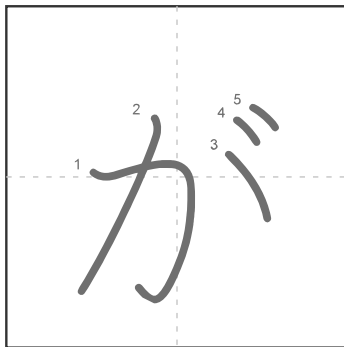
ん hiragana • 1 stroke

n

katakana ん

The marks go on last

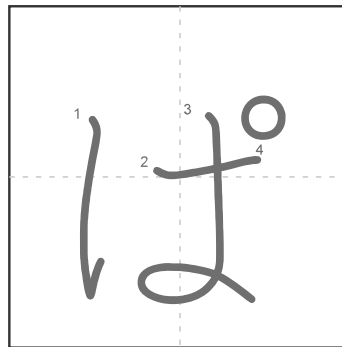
Finish the kana first, then add the mark at its top right: two short strokes, left one first, or one small circle. The book's answer boxes ask for exactly this. A small kana is written stroke for stroke like the full-size one, only smaller and lower in the square.



が hiragana • 5 strokes

ga

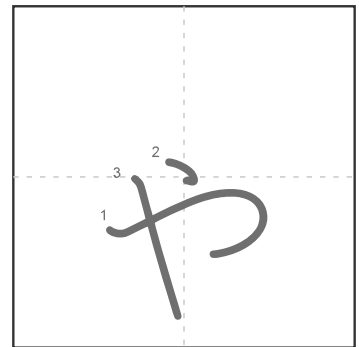
か, then the two marks



ぱ hiragana • 4 strokes

pa

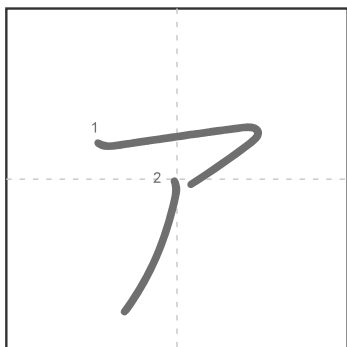
は, then the circle



や hiragana • 3 strokes

small ya

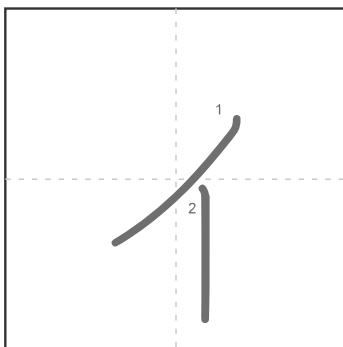
as in じゃあね, jāne



ア katakana • 2 strokes

a

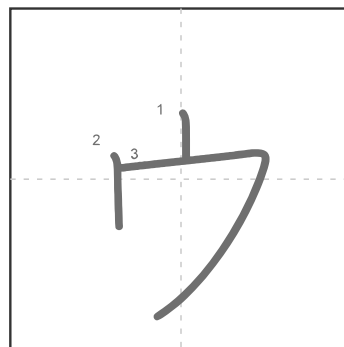
hiragana あ



イ katakana • 2 strokes

i

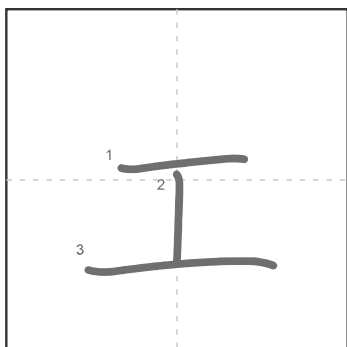
hiragana い



ウ katakana • 3 strokes

u

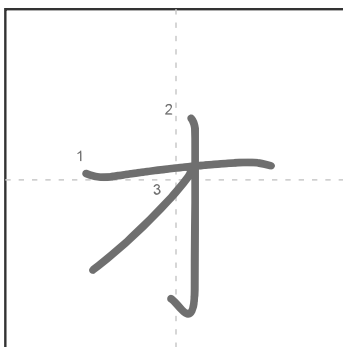
hiragana う



エ katakana • 3 strokes

e

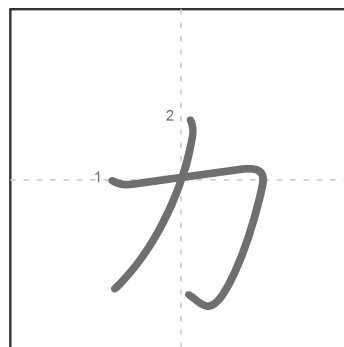
hiragana え



オ katakana • 3 strokes

o

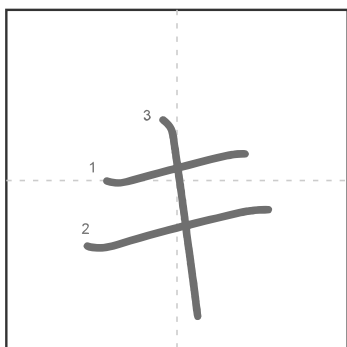
hiragana お



カ katakana • 2 strokes

ka

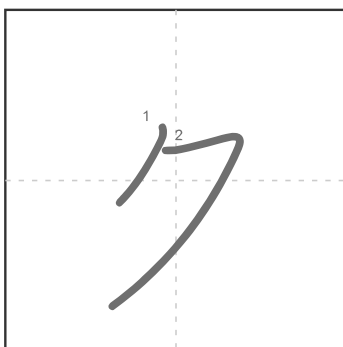
hiragana か



キ katakana • 3 strokes

ki

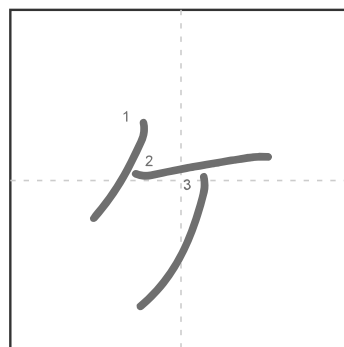
hiragana き



ク katakana • 2 strokes

ku

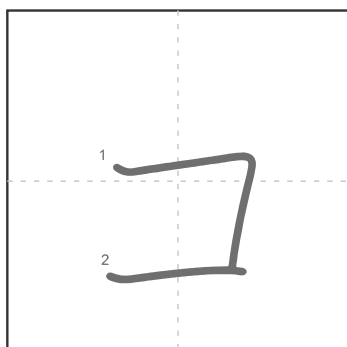
hiragana く



ケ katakana • 3 strokes

ke

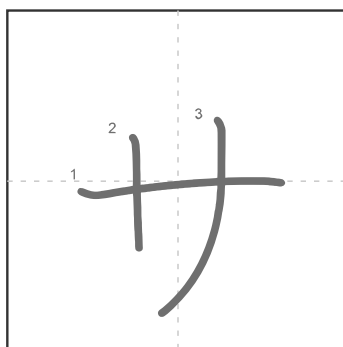
hiragana け



コ katakana • 2 strokes

ko

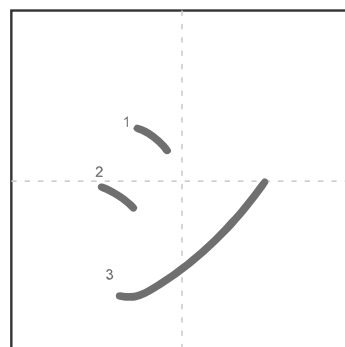
hiragana こ



サ katakana • 3 strokes

sa

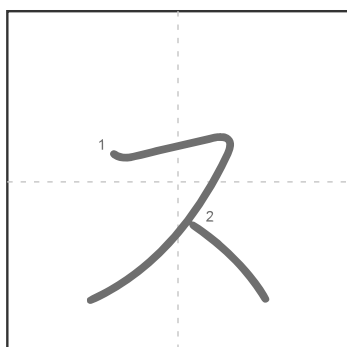
hiragana さ



シ katakana • 3 strokes

shi

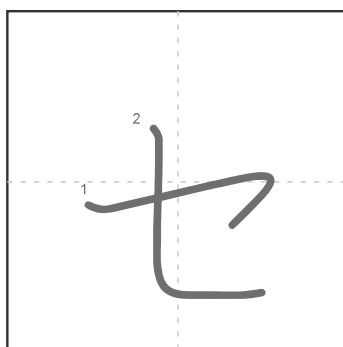
hiragana し



ス katakana • 2 strokes

su

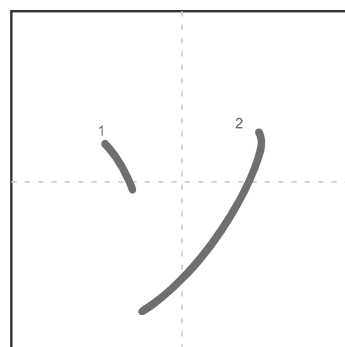
hiragana す



セ katakana • 2 strokes

se

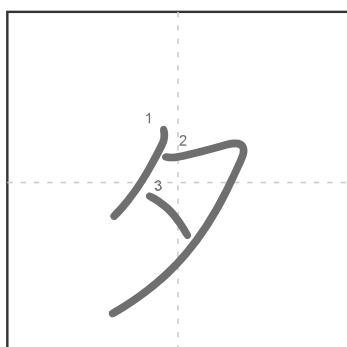
hiragana せ



ソ katakana • 2 strokes

so

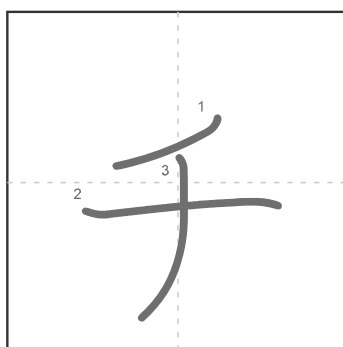
hiragana そ



タ katakana • 3 strokes

ta

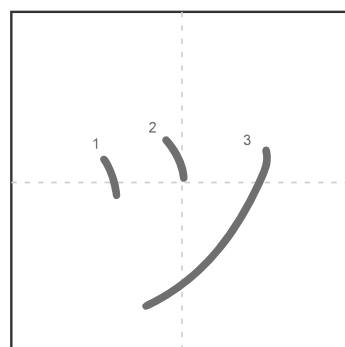
hiragana た



チ katakana • 3 strokes

chi

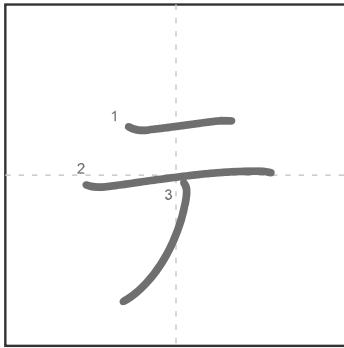
hiragana ち



ツ katakana • 3 strokes

tsu

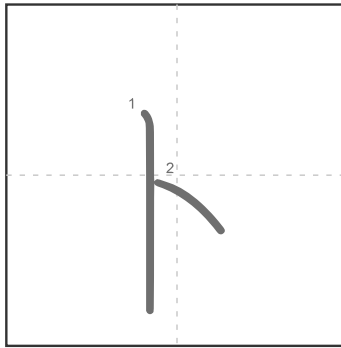
hiragana つ



テ katakana • 3 strokes

te

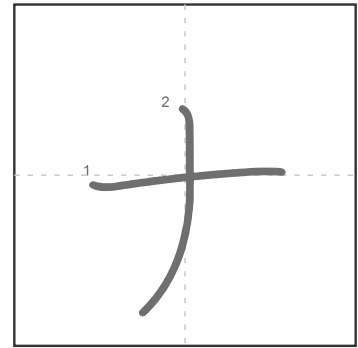
hiragana て



ト katakana • 2 strokes

to

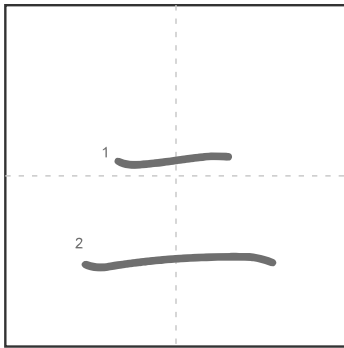
hiragana と



ナ katakana • 2 strokes

na

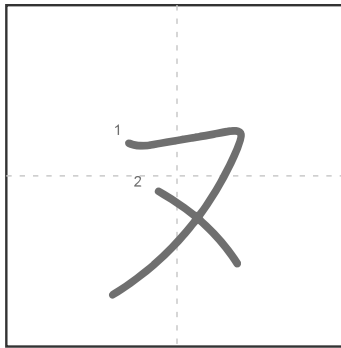
hiragana な



ニ katakana • 2 strokes

ni

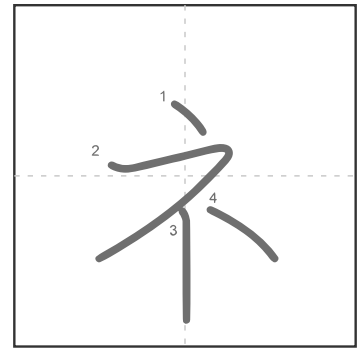
hiragana に



ヌ katakana • 2 strokes

nu

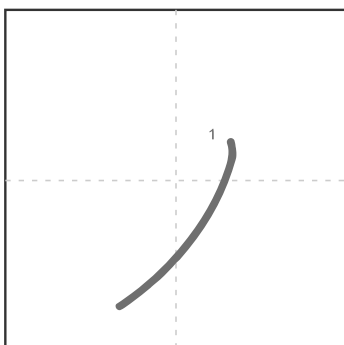
hiragana ぬ



ネ katakana • 4 strokes

ne

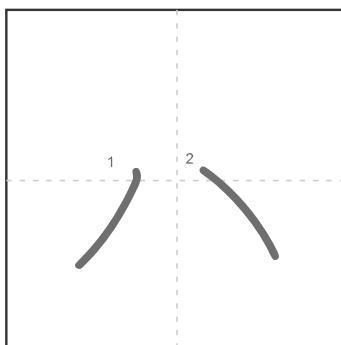
hiragana ね



ノ katakana • 1 stroke

no

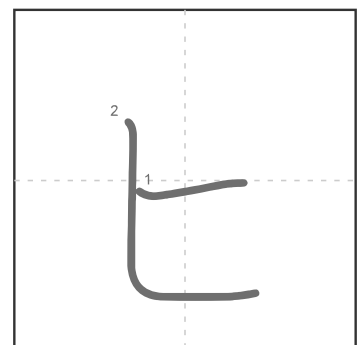
hiragana の



ハ katakana • 2 strokes

ha

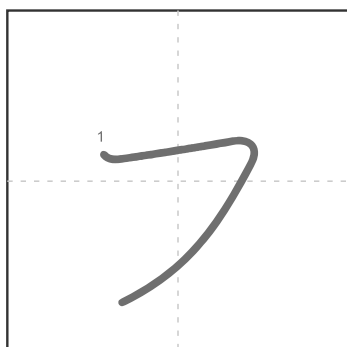
hiragana は



ヒ katakana • 2 strokes

hi

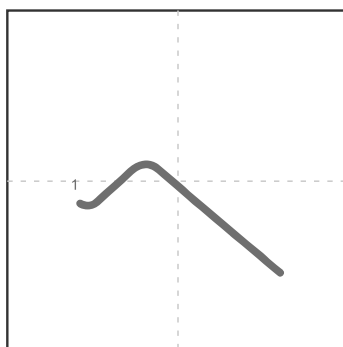
hiragana ひ



フ katakana • 1 stroke

fu

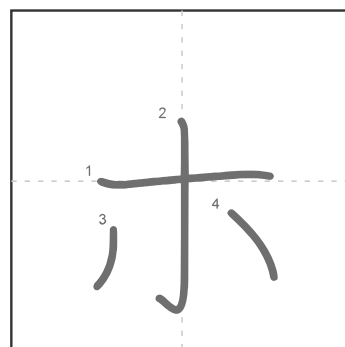
hiragana ふ



ヘ katakana • 1 stroke

he

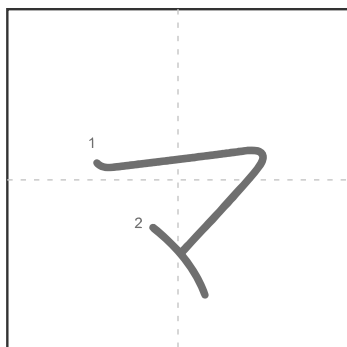
hiragana へ



ホ katakana • 4 strokes

ho

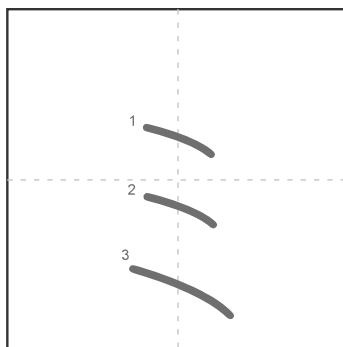
hiragana ほ



マ katakana • 2 strokes

ma

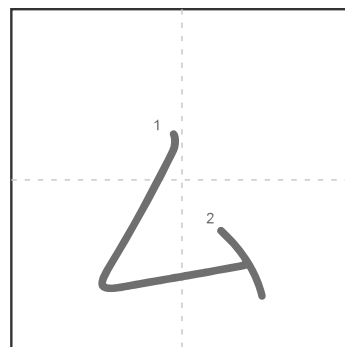
hiragana ま



ミ katakana • 3 strokes

mi

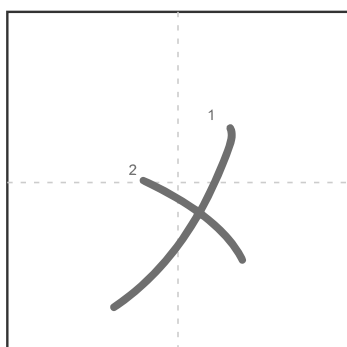
hiragana み



ム katakana • 2 strokes

mu

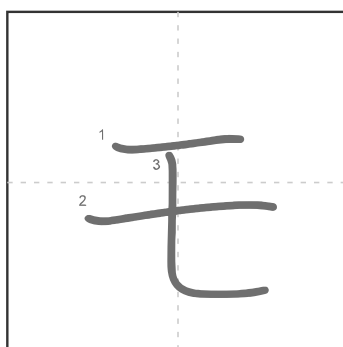
hiragana む



メ katakana • 2 strokes

me

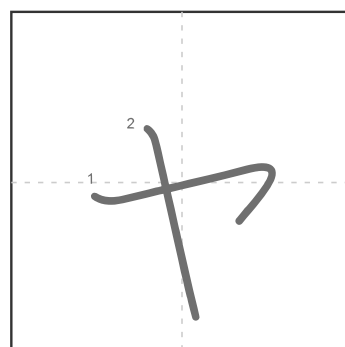
hiragana め



モ katakana • 3 strokes

mo

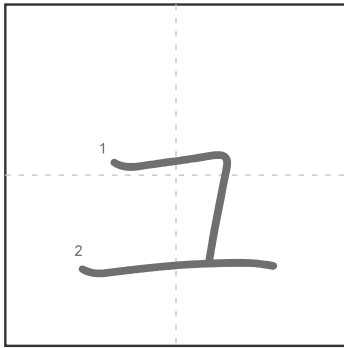
hiragana も



ヤ katakana • 2 strokes

ya

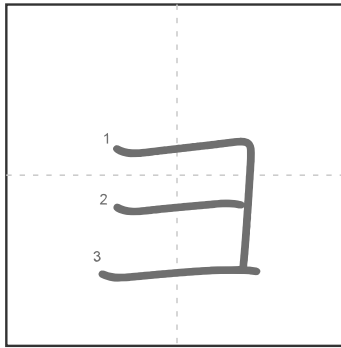
hiragana や



ユ katakana • 2 strokes

yu

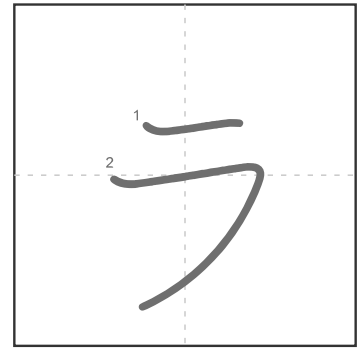
hiragana ゆ



ヨ katakana • 3 strokes

yo

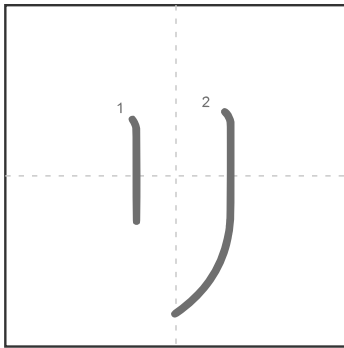
hiragana よ



ラ katakana • 2 strokes

ra

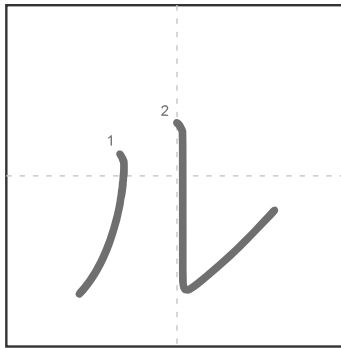
hiragana ら



リ katakana • 2 strokes

ri

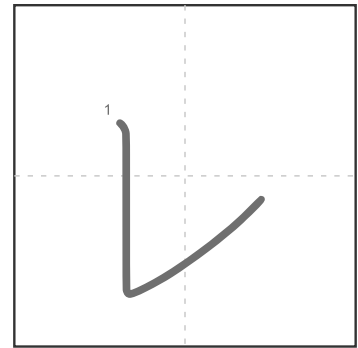
hiragana り



ル katakana • 2 strokes

ru

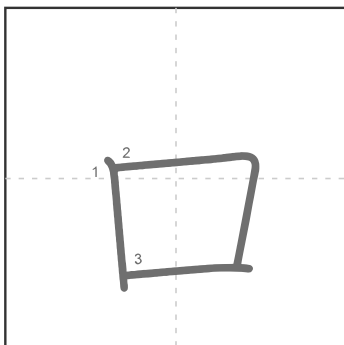
hiragana る



レ katakana • 1 stroke

re

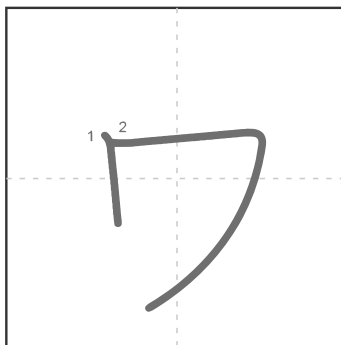
hiragana れ



ロ katakana • 3 strokes

ro

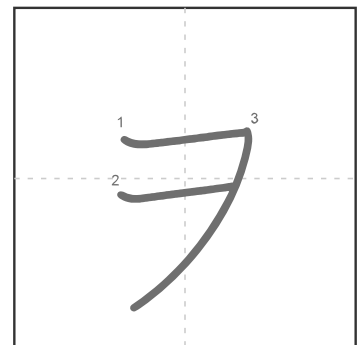
hiragana ろ



ワ katakana • 2 strokes

wa

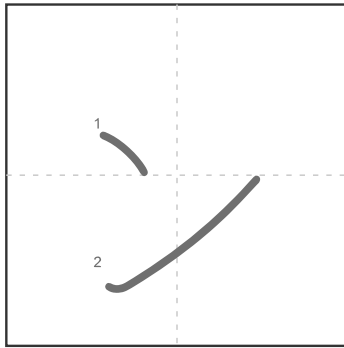
hiragana わ



ヲ katakana • 3 strokes

wo

hiragana を



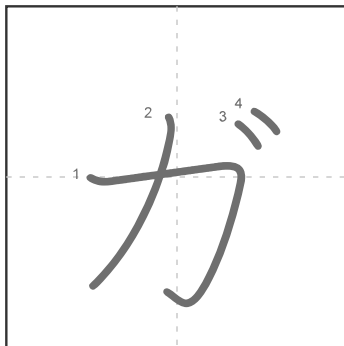
ン katakana • 2 strokes

n

hiragana ん

The same marks, and the long bar

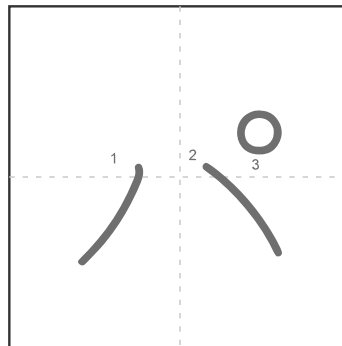
The marks work exactly as they do in hiragana. The long bar — is a single line drawn left to right, and it stretches the vowel before it. Katakana uses it constantly; the book prints it for you, but you will write it everywhere else.



ガ katakana • 4 strokes

ga

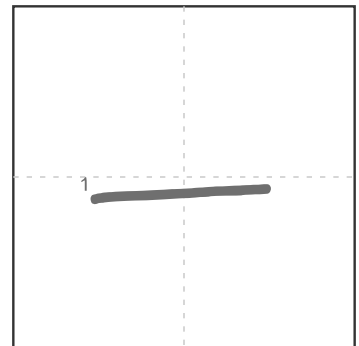
カ, then the two marks



パ katakana • 3 strokes

pa

ハ, then the circle



— katakana • 1 stroke

long bar

as in テーブル, tēburu

Kanadoku

Sudoku with kana instead of numbers. Solve the grid, read the shaded cells in order, and you have a real Japanese word built out of the kana you have just spent twenty minutes with. A hundred grids, hiragana first, then katakana, then the two together, and every one can be finished by reasoning alone.

This covers all 92 kana, which is the whole of both alphabets. What comes after them is kanji, and the Kanjidoku books each have a stroke-order download of their own.

Kanjidoku N5 and N4.

Where the kanji series starts: about 280 characters, six four-by-four warm-ups, and the vocabulary everything after it assumes.

Kanjidoku N3.

About 370 characters, and the compounds the sets there treat as ordinary words.

Kanjidoku N2.

About 370 more, and the first volume to hide four-character phrases.

Kanjidoku N1.

The commonest 500 of the roughly 1,200 the series counts as N1. Nobody finishes N1 in a hurry.

kanjidoku.net/strokes

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